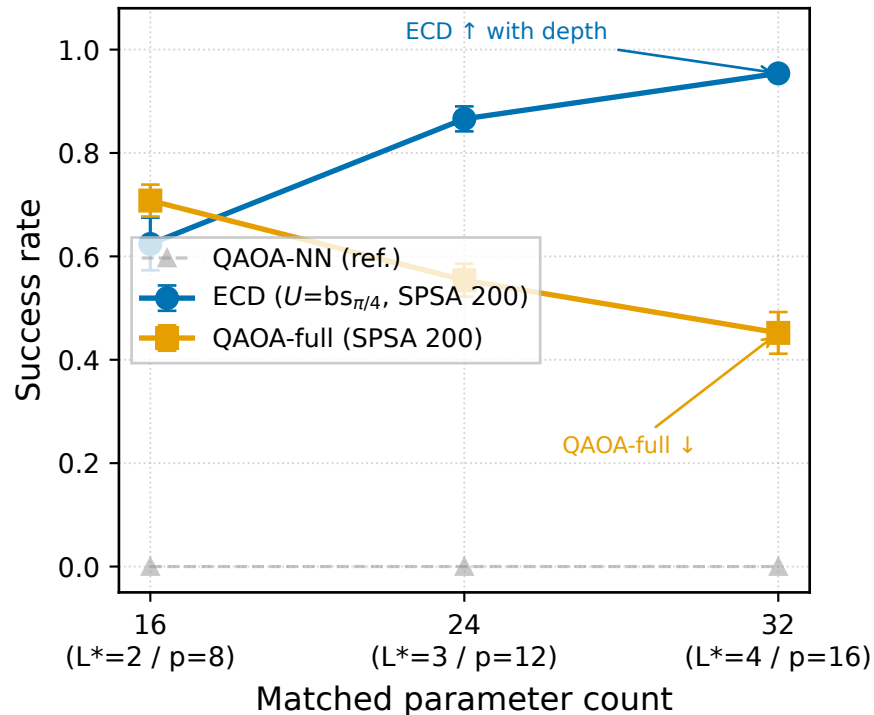


Fixed SPSA budget (200 steps): ECD landscape improves with depth; QAOA-full degrades

(a) Success rate vs depth



(b) Mean $P(\text{GS})$ vs depth

